

Creative Cauldron

Sonal Tuli is rewriting the rules of retail with Within's new four-storey playground in Delhi

By Ridhi Kale



I find myself perched comfortably on a beautiful dining table overlooking Delhi's MG Road, on a secret top floor open only to a few, being fed delicious food, with all the love and care that Punjabis are famous for. Then, there is a moment during our lunch where Sonal Tuli casually says that she doesn't want the chocolate dessert. For a journalist, this is the ultimate red flag. How do you trust someone who doesn't seek comfort in cacao? But looking around the sprawling new outpost of Within, the answer becomes obvious. Sonal doesn't need a sugar rush; she gets her high from *parchin kari* (pietra dura or inlay work) and stone carving.

In an industry fuelled by hyper-ambition, aggressive retail footprint expansions and loud main-road visibility, Within is doing something terribly unfashionable: they are happy to just 'be'. Sonal and her co-founder (and husband) Bobby Tuli originally didn't even want too many people walking in. But with their son Ishan joining the fold, the vision expanded, not into a commercial grid, but into a playground for what Sonal delightfully terms "designer greed" for doing more things creatively.

Within's design language is anchored in a holy trinity of storytelling, deep craft and what Sonal calls "moments of serendipity". These are the tiny, unexpected details hidden